

EPISODE 22 (SESSION 1)

Under the Chuppah

PRIMARY TEXT: EXODUS 19–20

A love letter for you.

My dearest, most treasured possession,

From the moment I imagined you, I called you mine. A special creation made of earth and breath—in My own image—of goodness and light.

I've seen you wander and wrestle with who you were created to be. I've heard your songs of celebration and your cries of pain. I've felt your hunger pangs and the stripes upon your back.

When you have felt abandoned in the desert or oppressed by the empire, I've been here, all along. Celebrating and crying and singing and wandering with you.

**... I've been
here, all along.**

It's hard to understand My ways, and I don't expect you to. That's not what I ask. All I ask is that you trust Me, trust the Story I'm writing. And when you start to doubt, don't be afraid or ashamed. That's not the kind of God I am. Instead, remember these words, these sayings. There more for you than they are for Me.

I am your partner for life. Always. Remember this when fear and doubt find their way in.

Love Me like you can never love anyone else, as I have loved you. Bring honor to My name, our name—to the image you bear with every step and move you make. Let it be one of radical hospitality, relentless peace, and unending grace.

Please make time for Me—for us! Spend time with Me, each day, each week. A rhythm of rest to restore your soul. Remember those long ago, quiet walks through the garden in the cool of the day? The sound of the river, the smell of the blossoms, the touch of the breeze? Keep time and create space for us to re-create moments just like that.

**Remember those
long ago, quiet
walks through the
garden in the cool
of the day?**

Never forget that I called you very good. So don't wish to be someone else. I made you YOU for a reason, for a time such as this. Believe in your self-worth! You are so wonderfully and fearfully made. Recognize this about yourself—that your worth lies in who you are, not what you produce.

Don't sell yourself short of the beautiful life we could live together. Don't throw us away. And don't take away from your own needs. You cannot love others well, as I've asked you to, if you ignore the love and care that you need to. So don't lie to yourself about what you need or what you're worth. Fight those thoughts of insecurity and anxiousness that crouch at your door, trying to tear us apart.

I love you.

Know that I am just enough, and more than enough. Don't listen to other voices that tell you otherwise. Listen to mine.

When a cloud covers you, a fire warms you, thunder rolls, or a seemingly unknown wilderness lies before you, remember My promises.

Remember Me.

I am your partner for life. Take My hand, again and again, and join me in putting the Kingdom, our garden, back together.

**Take My
hand, again
and again.**

PRAYER

*To the God who binds us to Himself,
brings us out of bondage,
and never forsakes us.*

*We take You above all
and seek to honor Your Name in all we do.
In how we rest. How we celebrate. How we work.
And how we choose to live.
May we remember Your words to us,
and keep our promises to You.
For You've given us so many reminders,
not just subtle signs,
of Your love.*

*Thank you for calling us Your treasured possession.
May we believe it and live as such.
Amen*

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 22

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What might be important to meditate over within these chapters of Exodus? What Text could you memorize or dig deeper into? What resonates or challenges you to learn more?



COMMUNITY

How does your community seek to love God by keeping His "sayings" together? How might this change your communal thoughts on the Ten Commandments and the Law of Torah?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from relearning or rehearsing the story of the Ten Commandments in this way? Who needs to see in real time what it looks like to be loved and enter into an intimate relationship with God as pictured in this story?



WRESTLING

What are you wrestling with? What is unsettling or confusing? About the imagery of the betrothal covenant? About the language of commandments versus sayings? What could you study more deeply? Remember—wrestling is good!



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*What spiritual practices or disciplines might you need to connect with God? We believe that **if we do our part in creating space for God, He will fill it.** How might the smallest practice make you readily available to God—to give Him all your heart, soul, and strength like you would the lover of your soul? How have you created space to hear God speak or take walks with you in the cool of the day, or remind you of the sayings He's made for you?*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

***We believe young adults are shaping the future,** and they need to be shown by people just like you not just how to follow rules or check boxes, but to live like the bride of Christ. To love God as a partner of your life and to believe and live as such. Young adults are open to this Jesus—they simply need people to show them what it truly looks like to live like Him and be one of His followers. What young adults might you invite into this?*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Living like Jesus and like His Church isn't just for Sunday mornings or Bible study; it's about living like Him in our everyday lives. How might you put this call of God on display in how you pursue and experience your 9–5? Does your physical work put you in a position to love God before others? To keep space and time for Him during the week, and model that for those you work under or supervise? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products should show God's love for us, our love for Him, and how He is countercultural to the love of empire. **You are doing a sacred work—no matter where you are.** Do it so that it reflects the honor and all the sayings of the God you love, who loves you, and loves the world.*